Seung Deok Seo

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Education

University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign — United States
Ph.D. in Political Science — 2022–Present
Fields: Comparative Politics, International Relations

London School of Economics and Political Science — United Kingdom
M.Sc. in Development Studies

Hankuk University of Foreign Studies (HUFS) — Republic of Korea
B.A. in Arabic Interpretation and Translation; Minor in Political Science
Study abroad: Cairo University (Egypt); University of Jordan (Jordan)

Academic Affiliations

Center for Strategic Studies, University of Jordan — Jordan
Visiting Researcher — 2026–Present

Working Papers

[1] Do Cross-National Aid Allocation Patterns Travel Sub-Nationally? Evidence from Saudi Aid Allocation in Indonesia *(with Paul Un; under review)*

[2] Together in Public, Apart in Practice: Credit Competition and Strategic Shallowness in Civil Society Cooperation *(Dissertation Project)*

[3] Whose Aid Is Trusted: Donor Identity and Religious Congruence in Egypt and Indonesia *(with Paul Un)*

[4] Staying Registered, Going Quiet: How Restrictive NGO Laws Suppress Civil Society Activity *(with Tae Il Kim)*

Fellowships, Grants & Awards

Internal — University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign

Graduate College Dissertation Travel Grant, $5,000	2026
Graduate Research and Professionalization Fund, $2,000 *(with Paul Un)*	2026
Graduate Research and Professionalization Fund, $1,200 *(dissertation fieldwork)*	2026
Evelyne Accad and Paul Vieille Research Award, $1,000	2026
Student Organization Resource Fee (SORF) Grant, $100	2026
Facilitating Learning Excellence Award for Teaching *(PS 241, PS 282)*	2025, 2026
Departmental Travel and Training Support, $800 total	2024–2026
Illinois Global Institute Language Fellowship (Arabic), $20,000	2024–2025
Kneier Fellowship, $3,927	2023

External

IQMR Open Pool Fellowship, $3,085 — 2026

Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies (IHS), $3,000 — 2026

IHS Graduate Papers Workshop, Honorarium and Travel Support, $1,400 — 2026

SICSS: Fully Funded (tuition and lodging) — 2025

ISA–Midwest: Conference Travel Grant, $250 — 2024

HUFS: Study Abroad Scholarship *(University of Jordan)*, $3,700

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record, University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign

PS 201: U.S. Racial and Ethnic Politics *(online)* — Fall 2026

Research Mentor, Undergraduate Research Apprenticeship Program (URAP)

Supervising undergraduate research assistants on dissertation research — 2026–Present

Teaching Assistant, University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign

PS 282: Governing Globalization — Discussion Leader — Spring 2026

PS 241: Comparative Politics in the Global South — Discussion Leader — Fall 2025

PS 322: Law and Public Policy — Spring 2024

PS 250: Rise Up: Organizing Resistance — Fall 2023

Research Presentations

IHS Graduate Papers Workshop, University of Washington *(invited)* — 2026

— *on Civil Society and Political Economy*

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting — 2026

International Studies Association Annual Convention — 2025, 2027 (forthcoming)

International Studies Association–Midwest Annual Convention — 2024, 2025

Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference — 2024

Fieldwork

Jordan: Dissertation fieldwork *(October 2026–Present)*

Additional Training

Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research (IQMR) — United States

Qualitative Causal Inference; Process Tracing and Typological Theories — 2026

Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS) — Republic of Korea

Text as Data; Machine Learning — 2025

Hebrew University of Jerusalem (Rothberg International School) — Israel

Summer Course: The History of the Arab–Israeli Conflict

Bourguiba Institute of Modern Languages — Tunisia

Arabic Language Training (Modern Standard Arabic)

Professional Experience

Korea International Cooperation Agency (KOICA), Iraq Office — Iraq, Remote

Development Cooperation Junior Consultant — Middle East / North Africa — 2021

	UN Women, Palestine Country Office	Palestinian Territories
	Social Media and Youth Engagement Officer	2018–2020
Service	Judge, Undergraduate Honors Thesis Poster Session	2025
	Peer Mentor, PSGSA Graduate Mentorship Program	2023, 2024
	Member, PSGSA Survey Committee	2024
Languages	Korean (native); English (fluent); Arabic (advanced — Modern Standard and Levantine)	
Skills	R, Python, LaTeX, Qualtrics	